

As part of the project "Support pool of experts" of the European Data Protection Board, which aims to provide support to supervisory authorities in carrying out their tasks, the Agency for Personal Data Protection is organizing a free online workshop titled "Data Protection and Compliance with GDPR in the Healthcare Sector," which will take place on Thursday, September 28, 2023, from 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM.

We invite all data protection officers and healthcare professionals not to miss this excellent opportunity to gain the necessary knowledge about the protection of their patients' personal data!

You can register via the online form at the link: <https://ec.europa.eu/eusurvey/runner/DPO-zdravstvo>

Participation link:

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/87887806107?pwd=aWg3MFN0S2JmY1FWSVNTbDFFTy9kQT09>.

The workshop is primarily intended for data protection officers from the healthcare sector, but also for all interested healthcare professionals, and the program is tailored to the specific needs and concerns faced by officers and healthcare workers in their daily work regarding compliance with the provisions of the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and the legal framework for the protection of personal data.

According to research by the Agency for Personal Data Protection, data protection officers in the healthcare sector face the greatest challenges in understanding and complying with the legal framework for data protection. Their level of knowledge and readiness to understand and comply with the obligations arising from the legal framework for data protection raises many reasons for concern, especially considering that data controllers in this sector process personal data on a large scale, including special categories of personal data and personal data of children.

The aim of the project is to develop a training program designed and tailored to the specific needs of data protection officers in the healthcare sector, consisting of the following modules:

1. General training module covering practical knowledge with examples, case studies, applicable EDPB guidelines, national guidelines, and applicable industry standards for information security:

- Basic sources and concepts of EU data protection legislation
- Basics of the General Data Protection Regulation: understanding basic GDPR terminology
- Law on the Implementation of the General Data Protection Regulation
- Understanding data protection principles and their application in practice
- Determining the appropriate legal basis for processing personal data
- Special categories of personal data
- Rights of data subjects and obligations of data controllers
- Data processing security
- Contracts between controllers and processors, records of processing activities, breaches of obligations, technical and organizational measures
- Competences, position, and tasks of data protection officers
- Data transfer to third countries
- Modern technologies: processing personal data using artificial intelligence, automated decision-making, profiling
- Use of anonymization and pseudonymization
- Processing personal data via cookies
- Processing personal data via video surveillance

2. Personal data protection module in the healthcare sector

- Overview of the provisions of the national legal framework governing the public health system in the Republic of Croatia in relation to data protection
- Understanding specific issues and requirements for data protection in healthcare institutions such as hospitals, city clinics, and the health insurance system in Croatia
- Simulations of data protection impact assessments, conducting legitimate interest tests, determining the appropriate legal basis, developing privacy policies, maintaining records of processing activities,

data retention periods, etc.

Workshop participants will have the opportunity to familiarize themselves with the legal framework in the area of personal data protection, with a focus on the specifics of personal data protection in the healthcare sector, such as internal documents for GDPR compliance, technical and organizational measures that need to be taken to adequately protect personal data, data protection impact assessments, records of processing activities, forwarding, granting access to personal data to third parties (e.g., insurance companies), access to medical records in criminal cases, etc. Through concrete examples, certain ambiguities related to personal data protection that arise in the daily work of healthcare sector employees will also be clarified.

The goal of the workshop is to conduct training for officers for the first time according to a program developed within the EDPB project "Support pool of experts," to gain deeper insight into the problems and challenges faced by data protection officers in the healthcare sector, and to receive their feedback on how the program best meets their needs and provides them with the necessary knowledge and skills for the quality performance of this responsible duty. Upon completion of the workshop, all participants will receive a certificate of participation.

We emphasize that non-compliance with the rights to personal data protection and privacy of European citizens, i.e., violations of the General Data Protection Regulation and the Law on the Implementation of the General Data Protection Regulation, can cause serious reputational and financial damage to data controllers in the healthcare sector.